

Next, open the terminal window. Using the terminal window, run the "ifconfig -a" command to list all the interfaces on your system, as shown here.

```
# ifconfig -a
eth0      Link encap:Ethernet  HWaddr 00:0c:29:69:12:7c
          inet addr:172.16.0.108  Bcast:172.16.0.255  Mask:255.255.255.0
          inet6 addr: fc00:660:0:1:20c:29ff:fe69:127c/64 Scope:Global
          inet6 addr: fe80::20c:29ff:fe69:127c/64 Scope:Link
          UP BROADCAST RUNNING MULTICAST  MTU:1500  Metric:1
          RX packets:9859 errors:0 dropped:0 overruns:0 frame:0
          TX packets:1399 errors:0 dropped:0 overruns:0 carrier:0
          collisions:0 txqueuelen:1000
          RX bytes:1920894 (1.8 MiB)  TX bytes:233088 (227.6 KiB)
          Interrupt:19 Base address:0x2000

lo        Link encap:Local Loopback
          inet addr:127.0.0.1  Mask:255.0.0.0
          inet6 addr: ::1/128 Scope:Host
          UP LOOPBACK RUNNING  MTU:65536  Metric:1
          RX packets:372 errors:0 dropped:0 overruns:0 frame:0
          TX packets:372 errors:0 dropped:0 overruns:0 carrier:0
          collisions:0 txqueuelen:0
          RX bytes:22320 (21.7 KiB)  TX bytes:22320 (21.7 KiB)

wlan0     Link encap:Ethernet  HWaddr 00:c0:ca:85:00:ba
          UP BROADCAST RUNNING MULTICAST  MTU:1500  Metric:1
          RX packets:0 errors:0 dropped:0 overruns:0 frame:0
          TX packets:0 errors:0 dropped:0 overruns:0 carrier:0
          collisions:0 txqueuelen:1000
          RX bytes:0 (0.0 B)  TX bytes:0 (0.0 B)
```

The ALFA wireless card is represented by the "wlan0" interface.

In addition to the interfaces shown in the ifconfig output, there is another interface known as the *wireless physical interface*. We can identify this interface by listing the contents of the /sys/class/ieee80211 directory, as shown.

```
# ls /sys/class/ieee80211/
phy0
```

The "phy0" interface is the parent interface used to create child interfaces. Note that if you unplug and replug the USB interface, the "phy" interface number will increment by one until you reboot your system.